The Dhāraṇī Given by the Nāgas, called The Heart of the Nāgas

Nāgadattadhāraṇī Nāgahṛdaya · Toh 685 · Derge Kangyur

ཀཱ་ཤྱ་བཏྟེ་ཧཱ་ཏེ་ཐཱ་ཟངས་ཀཱ་ཆུ་སྙིཾ་པོ།

The Dhāraṇī Given by the Nāgas, called The Heart of the Nāgas, in Sanskrit Nāgadattadhāraṇī Nāgahṛdaya and in Tibetan Lü Jinpé Zung Lü Nyingpo, is a short dhāraṇī text catalogued as Toh 685 in the Kangyur, in its Tantra section. After a brief verse promising that whoever recites this knowledge mantra, spoken by the Buddha, will have nothing to fear from the nāgas, it consists almost entirely of long mantra formulas that invoke the great nāga kings by name and are aimed at neutralizing snake venom and protecting against serpents. A closing verse says that one who keeps it in mind day and night will not be troubled by the fear of snakes. Its colophon relates that Nāgārjuna brought it forth from beneath the earth and that it was translated into Tibetan by Tenpé Nyinjé, and it ends with the verse of dependent origination and a mantra of consecration.

In the language of India: nāgadatta ṅhāraṇi nāgahṛdaya nāma. In the language of Tibet: The Dhāraṇī Given by the Nāgas, called The Heart of the Nāgas.

Homage to the Buddha.

Whoever recites this knowledge mantra given by the nāgas,
spoken by the perfect Buddha,
for that person not the slightest fear
will arise from the hosts of nāgas.

tadyathā oṃ ari bari bibāra śabari śarbari māri māmaṭi ṭiṭa māmāmaṭi mābiṣamā bannaga phuḥ phuḥ śabarīye phuḥ phuḥ kumāra śabarīye phuḥ phuḥ kirāta śabarīye phuḥ phuḥ ṭhaḥ ṭh svāhā

oṃ śabari śabari mahāśabari binbha barbata bāsini kathayati sarba nāgānāṃ bāsukiśā bacoyathā nāmāhinsanū bannagaḥ idandriṣṭā samayaṃ nāgārjūnīyakaṃ

oṃ baṃ nāsarājānaṃ nāsārjāno jñābayati phuḥ puḥ ṭhaḥ ṭhaḥ svāhā

oṃ aṭi maṭi mahābidye yinate bibyarūbini hana hana sarba biṣāna dei sūtra gacchi gatirūbaṃ phuḥ phuḥ ṭhaḥ ṭhaḥ svāhā

oṃ sūtre bārbte sutiṣe svāhā

ihyemaṃ kāśyabo jñāba oṃti anakuli nakuli mahānakuli sarbbasya mukhaṃ bandha bandha biṣa bhakṣa bhakṣa phuḥ phuḥ ṭhaḥ ṭhaḥ svāhā

oṃ kadru nāgānāṃ māte mahābāśe saṃhara sarba biṣārtha debibhāta svābara jaṅgamānra phuḥ phuḥ ṭhaḥ ṭhaḥ svāhā

oṃ naguli nakuli mahānasuli hara biṣaṃ aṣṭānchaṃ nāgatajñanaṃ nabānaṃ ghoṇasānāṃ ṣoḍaśānāṃ ciṇṣikānāṃ

oṃ kabiśati byantarāṇāṃ hu āhara biṣi bhakṣala biṣaṃ hrīḥ kṣemaṃkari hūṃ phaṭ

oṃ kruṃsaḥ oṃ bāsuṃki oṃ ananta oṃ tikṣaka oṃ karkeṭaka oṃ padma oṃ mahāpadma oṃ śākhapāla oṃ kulika oṃ āstika oṃ bainateyakharabuccha draṣṭa ghoṇasa kharbarīyaka hansamālā cilura sauṇḍa subarṇṇarekha nāgarājaputrāṇāṃ ṣadabiṅśati nāmasrahaṇātra biṣanāste kālabar lānāstī phuḥ phuḥ ṭhaḥ ṭhaḥ svāhā

If, by day or by night,
while staying anywhere or moving about,
one always keeps this in mind,
one will not be frightened by the fear of snakes.

The Dhāraṇī Given by the Nāgas, The Heart of the Nāgas, is complete.

Nāgārjunapāda brought it forth from beneath the earth. This too was translated by Tenpé Nyinjé, as Künkhyab urged him to do.

nami ratnatrayāya. oṃ ye ṅharmā hetu brabhavā hetunteṣānta gatodya vadata teṣāñca lo niroṅha evāṃ bāhī mahāśramaṇaḥ svāhā

oṃ supratiṣṭhavajrāye svāhā

Virtue! maṅgalaṃ.

Herein is contained the Collection of Tantras.

Translator's Notes

• The closing line, "Herein is contained the Collection of Tantras," appears to be a volume heading for the following section of the canon rather than part of this dhāraṇī.

Colophon

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human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.